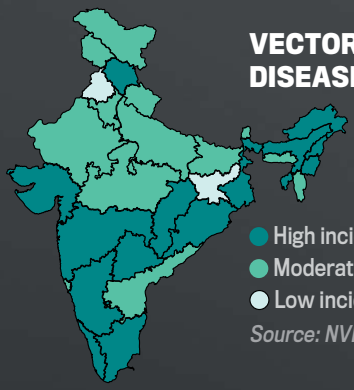
VECTOR-BORNE DISEASES IN INDIA



Source: NVBDCP, GoI

40 mn
Estimated number of Indians falling ill due to mosquito-borne diseases annually

17%
The prevalence of vector-borne diseases among all infectious diseases globally

WHAT THE AUTHORITIES SHOULD DO

- Focus on disrupting the natural cycle of breeding. A female lives for 15-20 days but can lay up to 1,000 eggs
- Release genetically modified mosquitoes that carry genes to stop the virus transmission
- Newer insecticides should replace the ones that mosquitoes have acquired resistance to
- Strict action against sanitation officials/ RWAs who fail to clear stagnant water, open drains etc.
- A coordinated effort by the Centre, states and civic authorities

WHAT TO DO IF YOU SUSPECT SYMPTOMS



- In case of sudden fever, body ache and chills, it is best to consult a doctor
- Rest and hydration are critical as much as the pills to treat the symptoms

NEW DISEASES BEING SPREAD BY MOSQUITOES*



West Nile: It is spread through the infected *Culex* mosquito. About 80% cases are asymptomatic. Symptoms that do turn up include fever, headache, body aches, joint pains, vomiting and diarrhoea. There is no vaccine yet, and treatment is symptomatic



Eastern Equine Encephalitis: Certain mosquitoes, including *Aedes, Coquillettidia and Culex*, transmit the Triple E virus from infected birds to humans. Symptoms may include a sudden onset of fever, chills and muscle or joint aches. Nearly 30% of those infected develop encephalitis (brain inflammation) and die

**No major outbreak in India yet*

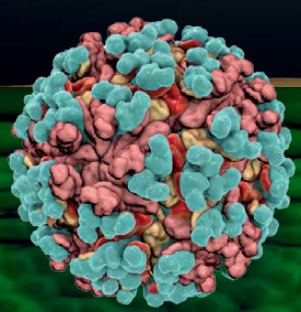
THE CURRENT DISEASES OF CONCERN IN INDIA



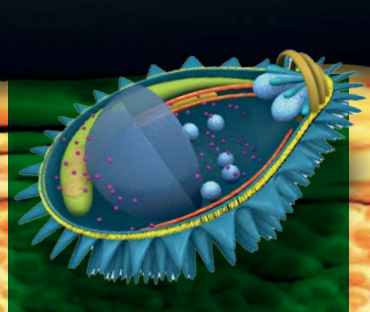
DENGUE
Spread by the *Aedes aegypti* mosquito, it can lead to haemorrhagic fever and even death in extreme cases. Over 12 million cases and more than 8,000 fatalities have been reported across 86 countries since the beginning of 2024



ZIKA
Transmitted primarily by *Aedes* mosquitoes, it was first reported in India in 2016. The real concern is that the virus can be passed from infected mother to foetus and lead to birth defects like smaller-than-average head size



CHIKUNGUNYA
Spread by the *Aedes aegypti* or *albopictus* mosquito, it leads to fever, joint pain, muscle pain, headache, nausea, fatigue and rashes. While it is not usually life-threatening, a new aggressive variant reported in Pune recently has raised concern



MALARIA
Spread by the female *Anopheles* mosquito, but also through blood transfusion, organ transplant or misuse of needles. Causes fever, chills, flu-like symptoms; if left untreated, it can lead to kidney failure, coma and death